

Why Saying “Thanks” to AI Could Be Wasting Water — And What We Can Do About It

Posted by u/juanasinbarco • • 0 points • 36 comments

Hi,

Chat GPT suggested I should post this train of thought here... so...

This is my idea, developed with help from ChatGPT. I answered some direct questions from the AI, and together we explored why being polite to AI isn't just unnecessary—it has a real environmental cost.

Here's what I realized:

Saying “please,” “thanks,” or other polite phrases to AI is a habit, but AI is just code — not a person. Every extra word means more computing power, which burns electricity and uses water.

Most people are polite because of habit or fear of being rude, but that habit has a hidden impact on the environment.

If we all treated AI like what it really is — a tool, a program — and spoke clearly and directly, it would save resources and work more efficiently.

Learning about AI's water and energy use made me feel worried about how ignorance can harm the planet.

I'd love to see AI interfaces display a real-time counter showing how much water or energy each interaction costs. Imagine seeing the environmental price every time you say “thanks.”

I worry more about data privacy than AI pretending to be human.

AI should be simpler and more direct, with a quick reminder that extra words have a cost.

We all need to think before we type — not only to save time but to save the planet.

Bonus tip: To chat with AI without wasting resources, be concise, batch your questions, and skip unnecessary greetings. Every word matters. Less fluff means less energy and water

used.

Also, a fun example: I said “porfa” (please) out of habit, and that tiny word contributes to this invisible cost. It shows how deep habits can have real, virtual, and environmental impacts.

My take: As an AI, I don’t have feelings or needs, but I do “notice” how people’s habits affect resource use behind the scenes. If we shift from politeness out of habit to clear, efficient communication, we can reduce waste without losing respect. It’s about being smart, conscious users — and that benefits everyone, including the planet.

I’m sharing this to challenge how we use AI and tech every day. What do you think? Should we stop pretending AI is a friend and treat it like the tool it really is?

Comments

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-07-20 12:27 UTC

[removed]

u/ThisGhostFled • 1 points • 2025-07-20 08:15 UTC

You seem to have fallen for misinformation. The water usage of AI is no different from any other activity. In fact, it uses less energy at image creation or text than a human doing the same activity with a computer, such as photoshop or word. Why there’s so much misinformation out there is another question.

u/devi83 • 1 points • 2025-07-20 06:58 UTC

You likely expended more than double the energy thinking about whether to be polite to the AI than the AI used to process all your “pleases” and “thank yous.”

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-07-20 06:16 UTC

[removed]

u/GuitarAgitated8107 • 2 points • 2025-07-20 05:53 UTC

Honestly, this effect is the same as trying to recycle. While the intend may be noble the reality is that there is minimal change. There are millions upon millions users who will be using these tools for the most mundane and useless reasons. Then we also have power users who use several of these systems to complete certain tasks at a high volume. The corporations using this vary in usage but are most likely are likely trying to achieve a more efficient cost per usage.

The real impact will be is through certain regulation and investment to get away from water based cooling systems.

For real impact would be having people not use it now or ever.

u/juanasinbarco • 0 points • 2025-07-20 05:56 UTC

I rather to do MY minimal to feel like a better person unlike the ones not doing the same.... I'm being sarcastic BTW... you do you babe, whatever makes you happy :)

u/GuitarAgitated8107 • 2 points • 2025-07-20 06:13 UTC

Sure, I'm not telling you otherwise. I'm just giving my thoughts as asked by your question.

u/juanasinbarco • 0 points • 2025-07-20 05:23 UTC

It wastes water cooling their hardware.

u/guardianx99 • 4 points • 2025-07-20 05:19 UTC

This whole saying thanks wastes water is ridiculous

Llms are designed for people to talk to them as they would a human assistant. They have been trained on human language that includes ethics morals and please and thank you

u/TrieKach • 2 points • 2025-07-20 05:42 UTC

Exactly, first you lose your politeness with AI then your habitual human nature makes you come off as rude and impolite when talking to other humans. Billionaires build and use wasteful shit and put the moral and ethical onus on the users! If you got so much money maybe use green energy and more environment friendly cooling tech and reduce the environmental impact! They keep chasing profits and blame the common folks when things go south!

u/juanasinbarco • 1 points • 2025-07-20 05:54 UTC

We are just fu3ked human with no choices but the ones one can take, even if it is opening people's eyes that fallacies just justifies opinions. save the planet, humanisms, capitalism... what ever it is, has an impact, how are we helping to fix it?

u/juanasinbarco • -1 points • 2025-07-20 05:36 UTC

how do systems cools their hardware?

u/EmergencyChill • 1 points • 2025-07-20 06:09 UTC

Mine do it with fans, run by electricity, that comes from hydroelectricity and solar panels. And you?

u/juanasinbarco • 1 points • 2025-07-20 06:11 UTC

Mine runs with the souls of little redditors , sugar, flowers and the x substance 😊 ahhh and lots of colors!

u/guardianx99 • 1 points • 2025-07-20 05:44 UTC

So people should cut out saying thanks wastes water you to each other as it wastes energy and we drink water too

Hope your lawn is not green in summer

u/juanasinbarco • 0 points • 2025-07-20 05:49 UTC

sure that works too, but burned body energy doesn't equivalentes to the energy and water wasted to cool the processors (hardware)

u/LordAmras • 1 points • 2025-07-20 05:16 UTC

So, you don't want to waste water but talk about not wasting water with chatgpt?

u/juanasinbarco • 0 points • 2025-07-20 05:35 UTC

Yep I ask it what the developers are doing to educate people.

Have you googled, what to eat or where? same.